We've seen in the last couple of sections how to amend an existing document. There are instances when we need to amend documents based on conditions. We do this using scripts, as discussed in the next section.

5.4.3 Scripted updates

We've been using the update API to modify the documents by to adding fields or updating existing ones. In addition to doing this on a field-by-field basis, we can execute updates using scripts. Scripted updates allow us to update the document based on conditions: for example, ranking a movie as a blockbuster if it crosses a certain threshold of box office earnings.

Scripts are provided in a request body using the same `_update` endpoint, with updates wrapped in a `script` object consisting of the `source` as the key. We provide updates as a value to this `source` key with the help of the context variable `ctx`, fetching the original document's attributes by calling `ctx._source.<field>`.

UPDATING ARRAYS USING A SCRIPT

Let's update our `movie` document by adding an actor to the existing array. This time, we don't use the method shown in listing 5.22, where we attached all the existing actors to the `actors` field along with the new actor. Instead, we simply use a script to update the `actors` field with another actor.

Listing 5.23 Adding an actor to the `actors` list via a script

```
POST movies/_update/1
{
  "script": {
   "source": "ctx._source.actors.add('Diane Keaton')"    <-- Additional actor
  }
}
```

`ctx._source.actors` fetches the `actors` array and invokes the `add` method on that array to insert the new value (`Diane Keaton`) in the list. Similarly, we can delete a value from the list using a scripted update, although doing so is a bit involved.

REMOVING AN ELEMENT FROM THE ARRAY

Removing an element from an array using a script requires us to provide the index of the element. The `remove` method takes an integer that points to the index of the actor we want to remove. To fetch the index of an actor, we can invoke the `indexOf` method on the appropriate array object. Let's see this in action, removing Diane Keaton from the list.

Listing 5.24 Removing an actor from the list of actors

```
POST movies/_update/1
{
 "script":{
   "source":
```